

Set Up Your Operation

ServSafe Proctor Business Setup Checklist

[FoodSafetyMadeEasy.com](https://www.foodsafetymadeeasy.com)

LEGAL & BUSINESS STRUCTURE *not required, but recommended*

- Choose your business structure — LLC is recommended
- Register your LLC or business name with your state
- Get your EIN — free, takes 10 minutes at IRS.gov
- Open a separate business bank account
- Set up a professional email address

YOUR WORKSPACE

- A private, quiet space dedicated to cold calling and client conversations
- A dedicated folder or binder system for client files, signed agreements, and exam records
- A printer
- A laptop or iPad

LEARN THE MATERIAL

- Study the ServSafe Manager content
- Know the Big 6 pathogens, temperature danger zone, and proper handwashing procedure
- Have a curriculum prepared if you plan to teach
- Know the exam format, time limit, and passing score
- Know the retake process, fees, and timeline

ORGANIZATION

- Plan your time — cold calling and prospecting, exam administration, client follow-up, and continuing education all compete for the same hours
- Keep your client files current — never let paperwork pile up
- Track your income and expenses from day one
- Set a weekly schedule and stick to it

BEFORE YOUR FIRST CLIENT

- Decide your rate before anyone asks
- Define your service area

- Set up a payment platform — Venmo, PayPal, Square (card reader attaches to your phone), or Cash App
- Have an invoicing method ready — Wave and FreshBooks have free tiers, PayPal includes basic invoicing, or a simple Word or PDF template works
- Confirm your ServSafe proctor number is active

BEFORE YOU GO INTO THE FIELD

- Professional attire — you are representing a certification program
 - A professional binder or folder for in-person cold calls
 - Business cards
 - A leave-behind one-pager — what you do, what it costs, how to reach you
 - Cold Call Worksheet — bring it with you, know it before you knock
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MY BUSINESS DETAILS

Business Name: _____

EIN: _____

Business Bank: _____

Email: _____

Rate: _____

Service Area: _____

Payment Platform: _____